

NewsX

Newspaper Studio - User Guide

Formatting tokens, CSV schema, highlights, drop caps, match-cut video

This guide explains every formatting option and data field NewsX understands, so you can compose single articles, generate them in bulk from a spreadsheet, and produce newspaper match-cut videos.

At a glance

Four workspaces: **Compose** for one article, **Bulk** for CSV batches, **Match Cut** for video sequences, and **Library** for everything you have saved.

1 - How NewsX is organized

Every newspaper image is built from one **article**. An article has a headline, subheadline, a byline (location and correspondent), and a **body**. The body is plain text, but you control layout by typing special **tokens** and **tags** directly into it. The Layout & Style tab then lets you configure anything you referenced.

The body understands three things

- **Block tokens** - `{image1}` and `{pullq1}` place an image or a pull-quote on its own line.
- **Inline tags** - `<highlight>...</highlight>` marks words inside a sentence.
- **Blank lines** - separate paragraphs (press Enter twice).

Paragraph rule

Separate every paragraph with a blank line. The first paragraph is never indented; later paragraphs get a traditional first-line indent automatically.

2 - Body tokens and tags

Type these straight into the Article Body. Each token you use appears as a configurable card in the Layout & Style tab.

Token / Tag	What it does	Where you configure it
<code>{image1}</code> , <code>{image2}</code> ...	Drops an image at that point in the flow. Numbered, so you can place several.	Layout & Style, Images (URL or upload, ratio, caption)
<code>{pullq1}</code> , <code>{pullq2}</code> ...	Inserts a bordered pull-quote block.	Layout & Style, Pull Quotes (the quote text)
<code><highlight>text</highlight></code>	Marks the wrapped words with a yellow highlight. Also the anchor for Match-Cut videos.	Inline - no extra config. Use the Highlight button to wrap a selection.

Example body

India has commenced distribution of E20.

`{image1}`

The rollout is expected to reach `<highlight>full coverage within one year</highlight>`.

`{pullq1}`

Tip - Highlight button

In Compose, select any text in the body and click **Highlight**. NewsX wraps it in `<highlight>...</highlight>` for you - handy when setting up Match-Cut anchors.

3 - Layout and Style options

Option	Choices	Notes
Columns	1, 2, 3, or 4	How the body text flows. Content fills column 1, then overflows into the next. Byline stays in column 1.
Canvas Size	Portrait 550x778, Square 600x600, Wide 778x550, Story 550x980	Overall dimensions of the exported PNG.
Drop Cap	On / Off	Enlarges the first character of the body, like a traditional newspaper.
Image ratio	1:1, 4:3, 3:2, 16:9, 3:4, 2:3	Per image. Photos are auto-converted to grayscale for the print look.
Image caption	Free text	Italic caption shown under the photo.
Pull quote	Free text	Shown between two rules in large serif type.

Highlights and drop caps in detail

- **Highlight** renders as marked text (yellow background) and wraps cleanly across line breaks.
- **Drop cap** enlarges only the very first visible character of the first body paragraph.
- Both are purely visual in Compose/Bulk; the highlight additionally drives the Match-Cut feature.

Export

The **Export PNG** button (bottom of the sidebar) renders the live preview to a high-resolution PNG and adds the article to your Library automatically.

4 - Bulk generation from CSV

The **Bulk** tab turns a spreadsheet into many newspaper images at once. Each row becomes one article; NewsX renders and downloads each as a PNG and adds them all to your Library. Download the in-app **Sample CSV** for a ready-made template.

CSV columns

Column	Required	Example / values
headline	Yes	E20 Fuel Begins Rollout in India
content	Yes	Body text. Use a blank line between paragraphs; tokens/tags allowed.
subheadline	No	Coverage targeted within one year
image	No	https://... (a URL). Auto-placed as {image1} if not already in content.
imageCaption	No	A motorist refuels with E20.
imageRatio	No	4/3 (default), 1/1, 16/9, 3/2, 3/4, 2/3
pullquote	No	Becomes {pullq1}, appended if not already present.
highlight	No	A phrase from content to wrap in <highlight> automatically.
dropcap	No	true / yes / 1 (anything else = off)

Column	Required	Example / values
columns	No	1 to 4 (default 2)
location	No	NEW DELHI
author	No	Our Special Correspondent
date	No	Sunday, June 21, 2026 (defaults to today)
articleRatio	No	portrait (default), square, landscape, story

How highlight and image columns behave

If you give a **highlight** phrase, NewsX finds that exact phrase in your content and wraps it. If you give an **image** URL but never wrote {image1}, it is inserted after the first paragraph. Same idea for **pullquote**, which appends {pullq1} at the end.

5 - Match-Cut Studio

A **match cut** stitches several articles into a short video, keeping each one's highlighted words anchored to the same spot on screen so the eye stays locked as the newspapers switch. Every article in the sequence must contain at least one **<highlight>** phrase - that phrase is the anchor (the first highlight is used if there are several).

Workflow

- 1 **Choose sources.** Tick articles from your Library and/or upload a CSV (same columns as Bulk; rows need a highlight). Click order sets the sequence.
- 2 **Prepare frames.** NewsX renders each article and locates its highlighted text.
- 3 **Adjust.** Use the controls below, watching the live preview.
- 4 **Generate.** Records a .webm video and downloads it; a player appears in-app.

Controls

Control	Range / options	Effect
Highlight position (Horizontal / Vertical)	Sliders 0-100% (Center resets to 50/50)	Where the highlighted text sits in the frame.
Zoom Match	Match highlight size / Fit page	'Match' scales each article so its highlight fills a set width (true match cut). 'Fit' shows the whole page.
Highlight width	30-95% (Match mode only)	How wide the highlighted phrase is, as a share of the frame.
Hold per Frame	0.30-2.50 s	How long each newspaper stays on screen before the cut.
Cut SFX	Audio file, toggle on/off	A short sound that plays on every frame switch.
Background track	Audio file, toggle on/off	A track that loops under the whole video.

Output format

Videos export as **.webm** (recorded from a canvas in your browser). They play in Chrome, Firefox, and most modern players. For MP4 or social platforms, convert the .webm afterward.

Getting a clean match cut

Highlight a short, similar phrase in each article (for example the same key word), keep **Match highlight size** on, and leave position centered. The words will appear to hold still while the papers change behind them.

6 - Quick reference

I want to...	Do this
Place a photo in the body	Type {image1}, then set its URL/upload in Layout & Style.
Add a pull-quote	Type {pullq1}, then write the quote in Layout & Style.
Emphasize a phrase	Wrap it in <highlight>...</highlight> (or select and click Highlight).
Big first letter	Layout & Style, Drop Cap, On.
Make many articles at once	Bulk tab, upload CSV, Generate & Download All.
Build a match-cut video	Highlight text in 2+ articles, Match Cut tab, Prepare, Generate.
Reuse a saved article	Library tab, click to load, or edit.

Troubleshooting

- **'Pick at least 2 articles with highlighted text.'** - Add <highlight> tags to your articles and save them first.
- **An image is missing on export.** - Check the URL is reachable; remote images are fetched through a proxy for the print render.
- **The match cut jumps around.** - Highlight phrases of similar length, or switch Zoom Match to 'Fit page'.
- **No sound in the video.** - Make sure the audio toggle is on and a file is loaded before you click Generate.
- **Bulk says columns are missing.** - The CSV must include headline and content headers exactly.

NewsX Newspaper Studio. Tokens are case-sensitive and lower-case: {image1} {pullq1} <highlight> .